

BETROTHY

Betrothy: Market Research and Go-to-Market Strategy

Betrothy is a community, with the tools and resources, to help with the transition from relationship to engagement, to marriage, and beyond. From the moment two people fall in love, through the wedding, and across the years that follow, Betrothy stands beside couples so no one has to figure love out alone. “This could be your love story.”

This document is a strategy brief grounded in what the product actually does today (see the feature inventory in the appendix) and in the product’s own landing-page positioning. Market figures are directional estimates drawn from public reporting (see Sources) and should be refined with primary research before any fundraising use.

1. Executive summary

Love is the most important thing most people will ever build, yet they build it largely alone. Couples navigate the biggest milestones of their lives, deciding to commit, getting married, and growing a life together, with fragmented tools and little community. The support that exists is transactional, and it ends the day after the wedding. Fewer people are even reaching marriage: fewer than half of US households are now married-couple households, one in four forty-year-olds have never married, and among those who want to marry, about four in ten say they cannot afford to marry on their own.

Betrothy’s thesis is that love deserves a companion for the whole journey, not a stack of utilities that stop at the wedding. The product gives couples a warm community, along with the tools and resources to help with every stage, from relationship to engagement, to marriage, and beyond:

- **Grow in love:** a shared space and creative tools, including a custom sung song built from the couple’s own story.

- **Commit:** an AI ring designer, and the encouragement and support to move from a relationship to marriage with confidence.
- **Celebrate:** the centerpiece, a conversational planning companion that builds the plan, budget, vendor shortlist, and public wedding page, with a gown studio, registry, and a guest experience that brings everyone into the moment.
- **Love that lasts:** after the wedding, a community and a growing set of tools to keep couples close, with shared experiences, trips, events, and date nights, through every anniversary and milestone. The research is clear this is what keeps love strong; couples who keep up regular date nights are about 14% less likely to consider divorce.

The wedge is the wedding (high intent, high spend, a hard date, and a moment couples want to make personal). The compounding advantage is the community: every wedding invites roughly a hundred people into a love story, and they become the next couples, guests, and supporters. That is a built-in, low-cost growth loop that single-purpose tools cannot copy.

2. The product in one picture

```

flowchart LR
    L["Fall in love<br/>find your person<br/>through real community"] --> G["Grow together<br/>surprises, shared joy,<br/>a custom song, your space"]
    G --> C["Commit<br/>the ring"]
    C --> CE["Celebrate<br/>the wedding you imagined:<br/>planning, vendors, registry,<br/>microsite, gown, song, guests"]
    CE --> F["Forever<br/>anniversaries, milestones,<br/>your community stays"]
    classDef be fill:#F6E3E8,stroke:#8B2942,color:#2E0F1C;
    class L,G,C,CE,F be;
  
```

The people you love run across every stage. Everything else owns one moment. Betrothy is the home for the whole story.

The strategic claim is not “we have more features.” It is “a love story is continuous, it deserves one warm home, the data and joy compound across stages, and the community from one wedding seeds the next.”

3. The problems Betrothy solves

3.1 For couples: love is celebrated in fragments, and it feels generic

A couple's relationship lives across a spreadsheet, a group chat, Pinterest, a registry site, a separate wedding-website tool, vendor emails, and a camera roll. Nothing connects, and the output feels like a template. Yet couples increasingly want the opposite: roughly 73% of couples planning 2025 and 2026 weddings reject traditional "rules" in favor of choices that reflect who they actually are (custom vows, curated playlists, signature experiences) ([WEDfluencer](#)).

Betrothy gives the couple one warm space where their love is the point. The planning agent answers a request ("build me a realistic 25k budget", "set up our wedding page", "find photographers near Sonoma under 3k") and writes it into the shared plan, budget, checklist, and public site. The creative studios make it personal: a custom sung song from their story, ring and gown explorations, on-brand colors, thoughtful surprises.

Problem solved: love celebrated across a dozen generic tools becomes one personal, creative, shared home.

3.2 For the wedding: planning is fragmented and impersonal

The wedding is the centerpiece moment, and the tools for it are transactional and manual. Personalization, which couples now demand, is exactly what template-driven checklists and directories do worst.

Betrothy collapses planning into one AI workspace and makes personalization the default, not extra work: the agent does the busywork, and the studios make the day feel like the couple, not a stock theme.

Problem solved: a manual, generic planning slog becomes a conversational, personal one.

3.3 After the moment: tools forget you, and the love story has no home

Wedding and registry tools end at the wedding. Relationship apps for couples, despite a growing market, suffer real retention fatigue once the novelty fades ([Market Reports World](#)). Nothing carries a love story forward or keeps the people in it connected.

Betrothy is anchored by a high-intent event and a real community, so it has a reason to persist: the network, anniversaries, milestones, and the people who celebrated stay present after the day.

Problem solved: a one-time transaction becomes a durable home for a relationship and the people in it.

3.4 For the people: community is an afterthought

Guests, family, friends, planners, and vendors are treated as transactions. They get a paper invite, attend, and leave. There is no shared joy, no easy way to participate, and no path from “I was part of this love story” to “now mine.”

Betrothy makes the people first-class: guests discover each other, leave wishes, watch the live stream, contribute to the registry, and share the joy, and they are then one tap from their own story.

Problem solved: a sidelined audience becomes an engaged, joyful community that also grows the network.

3.5 What the research says, and how Betrothy answers it

The retreat from marriage is well documented (see the deep dive in [why-cohabitation-not-marriage-research.md](#)). The most useful finding is that this is not a loss of desire. About 7 in 10 never married young adults still say they want to marry someday. The gap is between that desire and the conditions: marriage now feels expensive and out of reach, couples navigate it alone, the wedding is overwhelming, and the community and shared norms that once carried couples forward have thinned.

That reframes the opportunity. Betrothy does not try to manufacture desire or reverse a macro trend. It removes the conditions standing between couples who already want lasting love and actually getting there. The levers the evidence says genuinely help are, almost one for one, what the platform is built to do.

What the research says drives the problem	How Betrothy answers it	Status
It is expensive, and the financial “readiness bar”	The planning agent and budget tool turn a vague	Core

What the research says drives the problem	How Betrothy answers it	Status
is high (about 41% cite money as a major reason they are not married; marriage has become a capstone claimed only after you have arrived; the average US wedding runs about 34k USD)	bar into a concrete, reachable plan; the vendor marketplace and the registry with cash gifting lower and spread the cost	
Couples are alone, with almost no community, just as community and shared norms are the strongest correlates of marriage	The community feed, network, messaging, and matchmaker, plus the loop where every wedding invites about a hundred people in, recreate social support without requiring religion	Core
The wedding is overwhelming (about 94% feel stressed planning)	The conversational planning companion handles the demanding work: plan, budget, checklist, and vendor shortlist	Core
Couples slide into commitment rather than decide it, and deliberate deciding is the most robust predictor of lasting commitment	Shared spaces and milestone moments nudge couples to build deliberately toward marriage rather than drift	Partly, implicit
Investing in the relationship after the wedding keeps love strong (couples who keep regular date nights are about 14% less likely to consider divorce)	The love-that-lasts layer: experiences, events, date nights, and anniversaries	Roadmap
Relationship and premarital education	Not yet a product; the agent does planning, not	Opportunity

What the research says drives the problem	How Betrothy answers it	Status
improves communication and commitment	relationship coaching	

Two honest boundaries keep the claim credible. First, Betrothy cannot move the structural drivers (men’s wages, secularization, the broad cultural devaluation of marriage, or the class divide in who marries); it works on the margin, for the large share of couples who already want marriage. Second, the strongest claim is the narrow one the evidence supports: the product scaffolds the specific behaviors that research links to lasting love.

The same analysis points to the highest-value features still to build: an AI relationship and premarital companion (which also fits the church go-to-market, since premarital programs are exactly what marriage ministries run), an explicit deciding-not-sliding readiness surface, and the love-that-lasts tools the date-night research backs. These are sequenced in the **product roadmap**, where the relationship companion is the featured next item.

Problem solved: the platform attacks the conditions, not the desire, which is the right and defensible place to play.

4. Market value

4.1 The love and celebration economy

Betrothy sits across several large categories whose common customer is the couple and their love story. Directional sizing (US-centric unless noted, to be validated):

Category	Directional size	Notes
Weddings (total spend)	~65 to 70B USD in the US	~2.0M US weddings/year (The Wedding Report), average spend ~31k to 35k USD (The Knot , Zola via Axios)

Category	Directional size	Notes
Wedding and anniversary gifts	~21B USD in 2025, heading to ~29 to 32B USD (Global Growth Insights)	Shifting hard to personalized and experiential; experiences are ~41% of anniversary gifting (Accio)
Relationship apps for couples	~0.85B to 2B USD in 2025 (Market Reports World)	Growing ~13 to 17% a year; engagement and tools for lovers and couples
Bridal jewelry and engagement rings	global engagement rings ~5B USD in 2024, heading to ~8B USD by 2033 (Verified Market Reports)	High-ticket, research-heavy, shifting to personalized and lab-grown; broader bridal-jewelry definitions run much larger (scope varies widely)
Couples experiences and travel (the years after)	anniversary travel ~42.7B USD in 2024 heading to ~85B by 2033 (Growth Market Reports); romance travel growing ~24% a year (Global Growth Insights)	The lifelong layer beyond the wedding; couples spend ~2,000+ USD a year on dates (BMO)

The structural tailwind is **personalization**: roughly 73% of couples planning 2025 and 2026 weddings reject traditional “rules” in favor of choices that reflect who they are ([WEDfluencer](#), [ResearchAndMarkets](#) via [Businesswire](#)). They will pay for it, which is precisely what Betrothy’s AI studios and shared space deliver and what template tools cannot.

The second, larger insight is **love that lasts**. The market is not just the wedding day, it is the whole life together, and that surface is underserved while fewer couples even reach or sustain marriage: fewer than half of US households are now married-couple households, one in four forty-year-olds have never married, and only about one in six adults say marriage is essential to a fulfilling life ([Pew](#), [Institute for Family Studies](#)). A company that helps couples reach marriage with confidence and then keep their love strong, with experiences,

community, and date nights (couples who keep up regular date nights are about 14% less likely to consider divorce, per [PRNewswire](#)), is serving a market measured in the years, not the single day.

4.2 TAM, SAM, SOM

flowchart TD

TAM["TAM: the love and celebration economy, globally
(couples, their weddings, their gifts and milestones, their people)
tens of billions USD of annual spend touchpoints"]

SAM["SAM: English-speaking, digitally-native couples + their communities
US first, then UK, Canada, Australia, Nigeria-Ghana diaspora
~2M+ weddings/yr in the initial geographies"]

SOM["SOM: couples reachable in years 1 to 3 via the community loop + vendor-led growth
early beachhead: tens of thousands of weddings,
each bringing ~100 people into a love story"]

TAM --> SAM --> SOM

The SOM is unusual: each captured wedding brings roughly 100 warm, emotionally engaged people into the network at near-zero marginal CAC.

4.3 Revenue potential per couple

Today's live monetization is modest per couple, but the surface to grow into is the entire 30k+ USD a couple spends on the wedding, plus the gifts, milestones, and keepsakes of the years after.

flowchart LR

L["At launch
Studio credits (\$5 to \$20 packs, or \$15/mo)
Registry cash gifts (0.9% fee)

~tens of USD per couple"]

N["Near term
Vendor subscriptions + featured placement
Booking take-rate on marketplace bookings

~hundreds of USD per vendor / year"]

G["Long term
Payments on the booked spend (venue, catering, photo),
plus anniversaries, milestone gifting, keepsakes,
financing, travel

~thousands of USD of addressable spend / couple"]

L --> N --> G

The strategic point: Betrothy starts with high-margin AI credits and a small registry fee (proven, live), and earns the right to serve the much larger wedding spend and the lifelong celebration spend as it becomes the home for the love story.

5. Competitive landscape

```
quadrantChart
  title Where the love story lives
  x-axis One moment --> The whole love story
  y-axis Transactional utility --> Love-native and social
  quadrant-1 Whole story and love-native
  quadrant-2 Love-native but narrow
  quadrant-3 One moment and transactional
  quadrant-4 Whole story but transactional
  "Betrothy": [0.88, 0.9]
  "The Knot and Zola": [0.7, 0.28]
  "Couples apps": [0.3, 0.62]
  "Registry apps": [0.2, 0.3]
  "Generic social": [0.5, 0.45]
```

Competitor	Owns	Gap Betrothy exploits
The Knot / WeddingWire (Knot Worldwide)	Planning checklist, vendor lead-gen, registry, websites	Transactional, ad-heavy, not AI-native, not personal, no shared love- story home
Zola	Registry, website, some vendors	Registry-led, limited AI and personalization, ends at the wedding
Joy (withjoy)	Wedding website, guest tools	Beautiful but narrow; no creative studios, no community beyond the day
Honeyfund / Minted	Cash registry / stationery	Single-purpose
Couples apps (Paired, Cupla, Lovewick)	Relationship check-ins, prompts	Narrow, retention fatigue, no wedding, no community, no creative artifacts
Generic social (Instagram, Facebook events)	Sharing, event RSVPs	Not love-native, not a home for the whole story, no tools or commerce

No incumbent is a love-native home for the whole story. Wedding tools are transactional, couples apps are narrow and fade, and social platforms are generic. That whitespace is the position.

6. Why Betrothy can win: structural advantages

1. **It is the home for the whole love story.** Joy and data compound across stages: the shared space knows the couple, the planner knows the taste and budget, the registry knows the people. Each stage makes the next warmer and better. Point tools cannot assemble this after the fact.
 2. **A community-powered growth loop.** Every wedding brings roughly a hundred emotionally engaged people into a love story at near-zero marginal cost. They become the next couples, guests, and supporters. This is the cheapest, warmest acquisition channel in the category, and it is endogenous.
 3. **Love-native and AI-native, not utility-with-AI-bolted-on.** The planning agent, the custom song, the ring and gown studios, and the shared space exist to make love personal. They produce shareable artifacts that spread the product at no cost, aligned with the personalization trend couples already want.
 4. **A clean, editorial, emotional brand.** The product reads as warm and premium (wine and cream, magazine pacing, hand-drawn marks), which fits the emotional weight of love and stands apart from busy, transactional incumbents.
 5. **Multi-sided from day one.** Couples, their people, planners, and vendors are all first-class, producing network effects a single-sided tool cannot.
-

7. Growth loops and network effects

The community loop (primary, compounding):

flowchart TD

A["Couple builds their wedding page"] --> B["Brings in ~100 people"]

B --> C["People RSVP, share joy, message,
 discover each other on Betrothy"]

```
C --> D{"Where are they in their story?"}  
D -->|"in a relationship"| E["Their own space + wedding"]  
D -->|"still looking"| F["Warm, community-rooted intros"]  
E --> B
```

The loop repeats and widens with every wedding.

Supporting loops:

```
flowchart LR  
    subgraph Creative  
        c1["custom song / ring / gown"] --> c2["social share"] -->  
        c3["new visitors"]  
    end  
    subgraph Vendor  
        v1["vendor invites past couples"] --> v2["couples join"]  
    end  
    subgraph Connection  
        m1["more people in network"] --> m2["warmer introductions"] --  
        m3["invite your circle"]  
    end  
    subgraph Content  
        n1["couples post real weddings + tips"] --> n2["SEO +  
        inspiration traffic"]  
    end
```

Each loop lowers blended CAC over time and raises retention, because leaving means leaving your love story, your people, and your memories.

8. Business model and unit economics

Three live or near-term revenue streams (see the appendix for code references):

1. **Studio credits (AI generation).** Pay-as-you-go packs (500 credits for 5 USD, 1,000 for 10, 2,000 for 20) or a 15 USD per month subscription granting 1,500 credits. One credit equals one US cent. Generation is billed at roughly 2x provider cost, so gross margin before fees is on the order of 50 percent. First generation per tool is free to drive trial.
2. **Registry cash gifts.** A 0.9 percent platform fee on cash gifts, routed via Stripe Connect, with the guest covering the fee so the couple nets the full gift.

3. **Vendor marketplace (near term).** Vendors list free today. The expansion is recurring vendor subscriptions and featured placement, then a booking take-rate, and eventually payments on the booked spend.

flowchart LR

```
A["More couples"] --> B["More people on platform"]
B --> C["More future couples +<br/>more shared joy"]
C --> D["More weddings celebrated"]
D --> E["More vendor demand"]
E --> F["More vendors"]
F --> G["Better vendor selection<br/>and trust signal"]
G --> A
D --> H["More bookings, more reviews"]
H --> E
```

The AI credits fund high-margin early revenue while the community is built. The larger, durable revenue is the wedding and lifelong celebration spend that the home for the love story unlocks once couples and demand concentrate.

9. Marketing strategy

9.1 Positioning and message

Lead with the product's own voice, which is already right:

- **One-line:** "This could be your love story." Betrothy is where your love story lives.
- **Promise:** bring your love story to life with thoughtful surprises, shared joy, and music, with the support of your community.
- **For couples:** "The wedding you've imagined," and a space that is entirely yours, from the spark to forever.
- **For the people:** celebrate and support the couples you love, and discover your own story along the way.
- **For those still looking (small, warm):** meet your person through the people you trust, not another swipe deck.

Keep the voice editorial, warm, and emotional. The category is love; the brand should feel like a beautiful keepsake, not a deals site or a dating app.

9.2 Channels by persona

```
flowchart TB
  subgraph Couples
    cp["Wedding hashtags + Reels of real weddings<br/>Pinterest +  
SEO (budgets, timelines, vows)<br/>Creator song / ring / gown  
reveals"]
  end
  subgraph People["The people who celebrate"]
    sg["The wedding page is the ad; RSVP is  
onboarding<br/>Discover other guests + shared-joy  
nudges<br/>Family and friends invited into the moment"]
  end
  subgraph Connection["Still finding your person"]
    cn["Warm, community-rooted introductions<br/>(not a swipe  
deck), unlocked as friends join"]
  end
  subgraph Vendors["Vendors and planners"]
    vd["Direct sales in beachhead cities<br/>Free rich storefronts  
as the land<br/>Co-marketing: vendors feature their weddings"]
  end
```

9.3 Content and SEO engine

- Real love stories as content: every published microsite and custom song is shareable, emotional inspiration plus social proof.
- Programmatic SEO on high-intent planning queries (budgets by city, vendor categories by location, timelines, vows, checklists), answered by the same data the planning agent uses.
- Shareable AI artifacts: the custom wedding song, the ring reveal, the gown render are inherently emotional, social objects designed to be posted.

9.4 Referral and viral mechanics (already native to the product)

- Inviting your people is the core action; instrument and optimize the RSVP-to-signup and share-the-joy moments hard.
 - “Bring your circle” unlocks (warmer introductions, shared planning) turn the community into a growth lever.
 - Vendor-invites-past-couples and couple-invites-wedding-party are secondary loops to build explicitly.
-

10. Launch strategy

10.1 Sequencing principle

Win a narrow beachhead where all sides of the community can be dense at once, then expand city by city. Density beats breadth: a wedding needs local vendors and local people, so go deep in one metro before spreading.

flowchart LR

P0["Phase 0: Pre-launch (now)
Waitlist + landing
Seed 1 metro: 30-50 vendors
10-20 design-partner couples
Harden the community loop + agent"]

P1["Phase 1: Beachhead (1 metro)
Go live with design-partner weddings
Their people are the first cohort
Prove the community loop + credit attach"]

P2["Phase 2: Regional (3-5 metros)
Repeat the vendor-dense playbook
Vendor subscriptions / featured
SEO + creator content"]

P3["Phase 3: Platform + payments + forever
Booking take-rate + payments
Anniversaries + milestone gifting
Diaspora corridors via Paystack"]

P4["Phase 4: Category ownership
The home for love stories,
from the spark to forever"]

P0 --> P1 --> P2 --> P3 --> P4

10.2 Beachhead selection criteria

- A metro with high wedding density and a strong local vendor community.
- A digitally-native couple demographic that wants a personal wedding.
- Ideally a city where the founding team can do high-touch concierge onboarding for the first cohort.

10.3 The first-90-days motion

1. Recruit vendors with free, beautiful storefronts (supply first; it is the harder side and it seeds couple trust).
 2. Hand-onboard the first couples concierge-style; make their weddings and their custom artifacts showcase quality.
 3. Let their people arrive through the RSVP, the microsite, and the shared song; bring couples into their own space and people into the joy.
 4. Measure the loop, then pour fuel only once invite-to-signup and signup-to-plan are healthy.
-

11. Risks and mitigations

Risk	Mitigation
Cold-start / multi-sided density	Go one metro deep, supply (vendors) first, concierge the first couples
Seasonality (weddings cluster)	Use off-season for the relationship and community surfaces and vendor onboarding
Retention after the wedding (the love-story home must stay useful)	Anniversaries, milestones, the community, and creative artifacts give reasons to stay; the network is the renewable resource
AI cost exposure	Already metered at ~2x cost with budgets and an admin usage dashboard; first-free-then-paid controls trial cost
Incumbent response (Knot/Zola add AI)	Move fast on the love-native, whole-story, community position, which a transactional tool cannot bolt on
Trust and safety (introductions, messaging)	Community-rooted introductions are inherently higher-trust; invest early in reporting, verification, and moderation
Payments / compliance (registry, payouts)	Build on Stripe Connect and Paystack rails; phase payments carefully by geography

12. Metrics that matter

flowchart TB

```
NS["NORTH STAR<br/>Weddings activated<br/>(a published page with real people invited),<br/>because it drives the community loop that drives everything else"]
```

```
subgraph Loop["Loop health"]
```

```
  l["People invited per wedding<br/>Invite-to-signup conversion<br/>Signup-to-new-couple conversion<br/>Connections made + messages"]
```

```
end
```

```

subgraph Mon["Monetization"]
  m["AI credit attach rate + ARPU<br/>Registry GMV +
take<br/>Vendor paid conversion + ARR<br/>Gross margin on AI
(target ~50%+)"]
end
subgraph Eng["Engagement / retention"]
  e["Planning-agent turns per couple<br/>Creative artifacts
generated + shared<br/>Network connections per user<br/>Return
after the wedding (forever)"]
end
NS --> Loop
NS --> Mon
NS --> Eng

```

13. Summary

Betrothy is not a better dating app, a better registry, or a better vendor directory. It is the first love-native home for the whole love story: tools and community for lovers, couples, and the people around them, from the spark through the wedding and into happily ever after. The wedding is the high-intent centerpiece; the community is the compounding growth engine; AI credits and registry fees are the proven early revenue; and the wedding spend plus a lifetime of celebration is the long-term prize.

Win one metro deep, let every wedding bring its people into a love story, and the community becomes the moat.

Appendix A: Feature inventory mapped to value (grounded in the codebase)

Stage	Feature (live in the product)	Strategic role
Find / connect	A warm, community-rooted way to meet your person (matchmaker over the real network, not swipe dating); social network, profiles, connections	A gentle doorway into the love story; network growth

Stage	Feature (live in the product)	Strategic role
Grow together	Creative studios: a custom sung song (theme extract + lyric rewrite + generation), gown render, wedding themes/colors, mood boards; the couple's shared space	Personal expression of love; shareable artifacts that spread the product
Commit	Ring designer: AI ring variations, jeweler estimate requests, collaborative comments	High-ticket category entry; collaborative and shareable
Celebrate	Planning agent ("Troth"): chat builds plan, budget, checklist, wedding page; vendor + people helper cards; durable background runs; native iOS app	The centerpiece workspace and moat; concentrates demand
Celebrate	Wedding microsite: hero, story, timeline, gallery, RSVP, party, vendors, FAQ, travel; guest social discovery; live-stream view; wishes	The community loop; the event as an entry point
Celebrate	Registry with cash gifts via Stripe Connect (0.9% fee)	Live revenue; reason to connect a bank and stay
Marketplace	Vendor storefronts: packages, portfolio weddings, reviews, booking calendar, Google Calendar sync, bookmarks	Supply side; future recurring + take-rate revenue
Forever	Messaging (DMs, attachments, status reel), posts/feed, notifications	Engagement, retention, the social fabric past the wedding

Stage	Feature (live in the product)	Strategic role
Money	Studio credits (packs + 15/mo subscription), AI usage + margin tracking, admin dashboards	Live high-margin revenue; unit-economics visibility
Trust	Auth (password, Google, Apple sign-in), email verification, roles, admin moderation, soft-delete trash	Table stakes for a multi-sided social product

Appendix B: Notes and caveats

- Market figures here are directional and should be replaced with cited primary research (for example The Knot Real Weddings Study for spend, and category reports for couples apps and gifting) before external use.
- The monetization ladder reflects the near-term monetization (credits at ~2x cost, the 0.9% registry fee) versus what is planned (vendor subscriptions, booking take-rate, broader payments, the forever surfaces). Keep the two clearly separated in any investor or partner conversation.
- The matchmaker is a real feature, but it is a warm doorway into the love story, not a swipe-style dating product, and it is intentionally not the headline.
- The Paystack payout path (for diaspora and African corridors) is researched but not yet built; treat international payments as a later phase. See [africa-market-research.md](#).

Sources

Key findings are cited inline above; this is the consolidated reference list.

- [The Knot: average wedding cost \(Real Weddings Study\)](#)
- [The Wedding Report: 2024 US wedding market statistics](#)
- [Zola via Axios: 2025 weddings cost more than \\$35,000](#)
- [ResearchAndMarkets via Businesswire: US wedding services market, rising demand for customized experiences](#)

- [WEDfluencer](#): 2025 US wedding trends and stats
- [Global Growth Insights](#): wedding and anniversary gift market
- [Accio](#): anniversary gift trends 2025 (personalized and experiential)
- [Market Reports World](#): relationship apps for couples market
- [Verified Market Reports](#): engagement ring market
- [Worldmetrics](#): marriage decline statistics
- [Institute for Family Studies](#): the societal cost of the marriage decline
- [PRNewswire](#): date nights linked to stronger marriages
- [Growth Market Reports](#): anniversary travel market
- [Global Growth Insights](#): romance travel market
- [BMO](#): Americans spend over \$2K a year on dates
- [Dataintel](#): couples counseling app market
- [Cupla](#): relationship management apps guide